

TSC TE244 Thermal Barcode Printer & BarTender Complete Guide

Step-by-Step Calibration, 1-UP vs 2-UP Zero-Waste Setup, Windows Driver Configuration & Bulk BarTender Printing

1. Understanding 1-UP vs 2-UP Label Rolls & Solving Single-Sticker Waste

Thermal label rolls used in retail stores come in two primary formats: **1-UP (Single Column)** and **2-UP (Dual Column)**. Knowing how the printer handles each format is the key to zero wasted stickers.

Roll Format	Physical Layout	Total Roll Width	Best Used For
50×25 mm 2-UP (Current Standard)	2 stickers side-by-side per row (50mm + 4mm gap + 50mm)	104.0 mm	High-speed mass inventory printing (2 labels per row feed)
50×25 mm 1-UP	1 sticker per row (50mm width × 25mm height)	50.0 mm	Single-item reprinting, replacement tags, retail price tags
38×25 mm 2-UP	2 compact stickers side-by-side (38mm + 4mm gap + 38mm)	80.0 mm	Small accessories, socks, compact toy boxes
50×35 mm / 75×50 mm	1 large apparel tag per row	50.0 mm / 75.0 mm	Hanging tags, boxed items, multi-piece clothing sets

■ How to Solve Single-Sticker Waste on 2-UP Rolls (The Rollback & Slot Selection Trick)

When printing an odd number of stickers (e.g., exactly 1 sticker) on a 2-UP roll, the printer prints the left sticker and leaves the right sticker blank. If you roll the paper back into the printer, a standard print will try to print on the left side again (which is already used).

Dolly POS Zero-Waste Solution:

- In Dolly POS Barcode Studio or Inventory Barcode Modal, select **Start Slot: Right Sticker (Slot 2)** ■.
- Dolly POS will leave the left slot blank and print **directly on the unused right sticker!**
- This completely prevents wasted stickers when rolling back partially used 2-UP rows.

2. One-Time Windows Laptop Driver Setup (For All Sticker Sizes)

To ensure the TSC TE244 printer stops after **exactly 25 mm** (without rolling 10–12 blank stickers), you must configure the exact stock size in Windows once. Follow these 5 steps:

Step 1: Press the **Windows Key** on your laptop and type **Printers & scanners** → Press Enter.

Step 2: Click on **TSC TE244** (or *TSC TE200 / TE244 Seagull Driver*) → Click **Printing preferences**.

Step 3: Go to the **Page Setup** tab (or **Stock** tab) → Click **New...** (or Edit).

Step 4: Enter the parameters for your specific label size from the reference table below.

Step 5: Go to the **Options** tab → Set **Darkness: 8 to 10**, **Print Speed: 2.0 in/sec** → Click **Apply** → **OK**.

50x25 2UP (Current)	104.0 mm (or 102.0)	25.0 mm	3.0 mm (or 2.0 mm)	Gap / Transmissive
50x25 1UP	50.0 mm	25.0 mm	3.0 mm	Gap / Transmissive
38x25 2UP	80.0 mm	25.0 mm	3.0 mm	Gap / Transmissive
38x25 1UP	38.0 mm	25.0 mm	3.0 mm	Gap / Transmissive

50x35 1UP	50.0 mm	35.0 mm	3.0 mm	Gap / Transmissive
75x50 1UP	75.0 mm	50.0 mm	3.0 mm	Gap / Transmissive

3. TSC TE244 Hardware Gap Auto-Calibration (The Button Trick)

Whenever you load a new roll of stickers or change label sizes, the printer's optical sensor must calibrate to the transparent gap between stickers. Perform this 10-second hardware calibration:

1. Turn the printer power switch **OFF** (located on the back right).
2. Press and **HOLD the PAUSE button** (on the front top cover).
3. While holding the PAUSE button, turn the power switch **ON**.
4. The printer will start feeding 2–3 blank labels to detect the gap sensor, and then **STOP**.
5. Release the PAUSE button. Press the **FEED button once**: exactly 1 row (25mm) should advance smoothly. Calibration is complete!

4. BarTender Desktop Application — Bulk Database CSV Printing Guide

BarTender is an industry-standard desktop software for TSC printers. Dolly POS allows you to export all your queued inventory stickers in **1 click into a BarTender-ready CSV database**. Here is how to print 100+ labels at once:

Step 1: Export CSV from Dolly POS:

In Dolly POS → Go to **Barcode Studio** (or Inventory Barcode Modal) → Add products to queue → Click **■ Export BarTender CSV**. A file named DollyToys_BarTender_Batch.csv will download.

Step 2: Create / Open Label in BarTender:

Open BarTender → File → New → Select **TSC TE244** → Set Page Size: **Width 104 mm, Height 25 mm**, 2 Columns (50mm width each).

Step 3: Connect the CSV Database:

1. Click **File** → **Database Connection Setup** (or Database Wizard).
2. Select **Text File** → Click **Next** → Browse and select the downloaded DollyToys_BarTender_Batch.csv.
3. Click **Finish**. BarTender will now have access to all columns: ProductName, Size, Color, Barcode, and MRP.

Step 4: Link Fields to Label Design:

- Double click the **Product Title** text box → Data Source: Choose **Database Field** → **ProductName**.
- Double click the **Size/Color** text box → Data Source: Choose **Database Field** → **Size / Color**.
- Double click the **Barcode Object (Code128)** → Data Source: Choose **Database Field** → **Barcode**.
- Double click the **MRP** text box → Data Source: Choose **Database Field** → **MRP**.

Step 5: Print All Records:

Click **File** → **Print** → Under Records, select **All Records** → Click **Print**. The TSC TE244 will print all barcodes consecutively with 100% precision!

5. iBall LS392 Laser Scanner Best Practices

- **Optimal Distance**: Hold the iBall LS392 laser scanner approximately **15–20 cm (6–8 inches)** away from the sticker.
- **Aiming Line**: Direct the red horizontal laser beam straight across the horizontal center of the vertical bars.
- **Darkness / Contrast**: If the scanner struggles, ensure printer **Darkness is set to 8–10** in Windows preferences. Deep black bars produce the strongest optical reflection for laser diodes.
- **Quiet Zones**: Dolly POS stickers automatically maintain a clean 1.2mm white margin on both sides so the scanner instantly detects the Start and Stop characters.